



CASH CROP

Indira Rajaraman

60, Economist

It was the lack of options, an unknown future and scarce opportunities for women in the 1960s that gave Indira Rajaraman, a member of the 13th Finance Commission, and Professor Emeritus at the National Institute of Public Finance and Policy (NIPFP) an ambition to create an identity for the Indian woman. She spent 18 years teaching macroeconomics at IIM-Bangalore. "There is a need to transmit our abilities and skills to another generation, so that they don't die with us," says the mother of one. She was the RBI chair professor at NIPFP and NABARD chair professor at the Institute of Economic Growth in Delhi. At the Finance Commission her quest isn't simple. Every state sees itself entitled to special privileges, like the border and coastal areas. Balancing the funds between the Centre and the states is always tricky, she says. Adding to that, "This is still a country controlled by men for men. The establishment looks at women with skills as something to be exploited," says Rajaraman, who continues to stride ahead to change the scenario.

FIRST INVESTMENT A bank account in State Bank of India in 1971 for my salary.

WORST DECISION I MADE I bought Unit Trust of India units in 2001, which lost value.

SMARTEST INVESTMENT CHOICE AND WHY To invest in the Public Provident Fund as it has a maximum limit on the annual deposit and is hassle-free.

BEST ADVICE I EVER GOT AND FROM WHOM My father used to tell me that the best way to remain solvent is to remain frugal in one's expenditure.



**USE
THIS
TIP**

"ONE SHOULD SAVE STEADILY OVER THE YEARS. INVESTING IN PUBLIC SECTOR INSTRUMENTS IS THE SAFEST BET."